



Greetings!

We are the **Community Development Board of East Parkside (CDBEP)**, a resident-led alliance composed of East Parkside stakeholders, block captains, and members of local community groups. We are committed to neighborhood preservation, revitalization, and the equitable development of public land to ensure maximum benefit to the community. We advocate for development that aligns with affordability, preservation, and community ownership.

We believe that residents are the experts in their own communities, and they should be leading the effort to shape East Parkside's future. Unfortunately, several recent developments were built against community values and do not respect our neighborhood's character and architectural history.

CDBEP is committed to preserving the unique character of our neighborhood for residents, which is why we are in the process of establishing a Neighborhood Conservation Overlay.

What is a Neighborhood Conservation Overlay (NCO)?

A Neighborhood Conservation Overlay (NCO) is a zoning tool enacted by Philadelphia City Council, based on resident input, that recognizes and protects the character of a neighborhood by establishing design standards for new development. This helps ensure that new buildings match the desired visual style of housing in the neighborhood in line with its architectural character and history.

In defining the NCO, East Parkside residents have the opportunity to guide the nature of future development in the neighborhood.

The NCO can...

- Recognize that East Parkside's architecture and streetscape should be conserved.
- Regulate significant work to a building façade (where it is visible to the public).
- Regulate the replacement of existing buildings.
- Regulate the construction of new structures.
- Maintain East Parkside's streetscape, visual qualities, characteristics, and building form (i.e. setbacks, porches, landscaping).

The NCO cannot...

- Regulate interiors or use.
- Stop demolitions.
- Overlap with historic districts (*this excludes the north side of 4200 Viola Street, 4100-4200 Parkside Avenue, and the 1700 blocks of Marlton and Memorial Avenues*).

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What is the NCO process?

The NCO process goes like this:

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- 1 Community members initiate the NCO process and provide proof of interest from 30% of impacted residents.
- 2 CDBEP will submit a background survey of the proposed NCO to the City with photos, maps, and descriptions of the neighborhood characteristics we want to conserve.
- 3 Residents will work with the Philadelphia Planning Commission to create community-based design guidelines that address community preferences for architectural elements such as building materials, setbacks, porches, and more that fit our neighborhood's unique character.
- 4 City Councilwoman Jamie Gauthier will introduce legislation for the City Council to vote on creating the NCO.
- 5 Future developments must receive a Certificate of Compliance from the Philadelphia City Planning Commission before building permits will be issued.

Who else has an NCO?

Several communities across the city have NCOs in place, but most notable for our community are Powelton Village (created in 2018) and Strawberry Mansion (created in 2021). These communities created NCOs due to similar concerns regarding new developments happening too quickly without respecting the context and history of the neighborhoods where they were being built. Since Powelton Village passed their NCO, several new developments in the community are more aligned with preferred aesthetics and character, compared to prior new construction.

How can I get involved?

There are two ways you can get in contact with us:

Share your contact information (most important)!

We are collecting resident contact information so we can take a vote on which blocks should be included in the NCO and key elements of the NCO's design guidelines.



SCAN QR CODE FOR CONTACT FORM

You can also:

- **Participate and share your voice.**
Attend community meetings where we share updates, gather feedback, and answer questions. Participate in surveys and neighborhood walks to help identify which architectural and community features matter most to you.
- **Join the Planning Committee.**
Volunteer to be part of the working group helping to shape the NCO proposal.

Questions:

Email:
communitydevboard@gmail.com

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